



The console of the IBM Stretch

financially or technically, its architecture influenced future designs in areas of core memory, transistor circuits, and circuit packaging. The Stretch computers were the fastest until 1964 and they led the basis for the runaway success of IBM's System/360.

April: The Whirlpool “is transistorised”

The TX-0 (Transistorized Experimental zero) computer was built at MIT. It was essentially a transistorised version of the Whirlpool computer. It was only intended for experimental purposes, though the original design was the basis for the PDP-1 computers made by DEC in 1961.

July: “AI”, the word

John McCarthy coined the term “Artificial Intelligence”; Allen Newell, J C Shaw and Herbert Simon introduced the Logic Theorist, the first program to demonstrate artificial intelligence. It was used to find the basic equations of logic as defined in the Principia Mathematica, a treatise on mathematics. It could solve most of the theorems in the same way a human would solve, and in one case even managed a more elegant proof.



John McCarthy, the Father of Artificial Intelligence